

Fantasy Football Expert Narratives - Signal or Storytelling?

It's the first week of the NFL season, and your fantasy football team is under pressure. Thousands of users are reading expert start/sit columns, waiver wire writeups, and weekly player outlooks. You've seen dozens of different analysts online, each one claiming that they can help you make the best decisions for your roster. It is time to finally investigate the reliability of these analysts who claim to have knowledge that can benefit your fantasy football team. You are going to dive into the sentiment of fantasy media, asking the question: Can analyst outlook help predict NFL player performance, or is it mostly narrative?

Fantasy football is a game where participants build virtual teams of real NFL players and score points based on those players' weekly in game statistics. This makes forecasting performance central to every lineup decision. To guide those decisions, fans rely heavily on media content where analysts suggest players to start/sit, talk about who is available on the waiver wire, and provide tailored rankings. These articles are written by analysts who use confident or cautious language to frame their expectations. At first glance, positive writeups should mean good fantasy weeks, negative writeups should mean bad ones. But in sports media, confidence and prediction are not always the same thing. Analysts may be influenced by recent big games (recency bias), player popularity, injury narratives, consensus rankings, and personal biases.

You are the reviewer assigned to audit the accuracy of fantasy football media's "expert" recommendations.

In this project, those narratives are treated as data. Article text has already been collected and sentiment is measured (ex. positive, neutral, negative tone), then compared with actual fantasy outcomes to test whether analyst tone provides genuine predictive signal or mainly reflects existing trends, recent performances, and broader media bias.

Your task is to decide whether sentiment adds predictive insight or simply reflects what was already obvious from known stats and public narratives. You should produce a short report that answers the following questions:

1. Are analyst narratives generally reliable for forecasting fantasy performance?
2. Is there any indication of predictive power in article sentiment?
3. What kinds of biases should be taken into account when reading fantasy outlooks?

Your conclusion should be an analysis of the expert sentiment. Make a claim about how helpful fantasy football media is when making decisions for your team.